



ALEXA WELCH EDLUND/TIMES-DISPATCH

Toffee Bars

Light, crisp and chocolaty.

Makes 30 bars

**½ pound (2 sticks) unsalted
butter**

1 cup light brown sugar

1 egg yolk

2 cups all-purpose flour

1 teaspoon vanilla extract

**12 ounces semisweet choco-
late chips**

**1 cup shelled pecans, coarse-
ly chopped**

Preheat oven to 350 degrees. Grease a 9-by-13-by-2-inch baking pan.

Cream butter and sugar. Add egg yolk and mix well. Sift in flour, mixing well, and then the vanilla. Spread the batter in the prepared pan and bake for 25 minutes.

Cover the cake layer with the chocolate chips and return to the oven for 3 or 4 minutes.

Remove the pan from the oven and spread the melted chocolate evenly. Sprinkle with the nuts and gently press them into the chocolate with the back of a fork. Cool completely in the pan before cutting them into bars.

— Adapted from "The Silver Palate Cookbook"

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